

# 1975

# REIGN OF TERROR



**THIS MEANS WAR:**  
George Fernandes  
being arrested

◀ REWIND

The Allahabad High Court found Indira Gandhi guilty of electoral malpractices, and she declared national Emergency on June 26, announcing on AIR that it was a necessary response to the "deep and widespread conspiracy which has been brewing ever since I began to introduce certain progressive measures of benefit to the common man and woman of India". Thousands, including Opposition firebrands like Jayaprakash Narayan, George Fernandes, Atal Bihari Vajpayee, were held under MISA—the Maintenance of Internal Security Act, dubbed the Maintenance of Indira and Sanjay Act.

## FREAK TRAGEDY

India's worst coal mine disaster occurred in Chas Nala mine near Dhanabad on December 26—372 people inside the mine perished as a result of caving in of a roof of coal, which let in seven million gallons of



water per minute. The Indian Iron and Steel Company, which owned the mine, said it conformed to international standards.

## FIRST CUT

- Durba Banerjee became the first professional woman pilot in the world to command a commercial passenger flight.
- Shireen Kiyash became the only

person to have represented India in three different sports—basketball, hockey and cricket.

- India's first electric typewriter was produced by Hindustan Teleprinters Ltd.